



Cyber Hygiene for Healthcare: Recognizing and Protecting Patient Data from Phishing and Scams

START

➤ *Click START to begin the course.*



1 Menu

Access the module outline and jump to specific sections.

2 Glossary

View definitions of key terms used in the training.

3 Close

Exit the module when you're finished.

6 Volume

Adjust the sound level to your preference.

7 Closed Captions

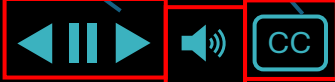
Toggle captions on or off for audio narration.

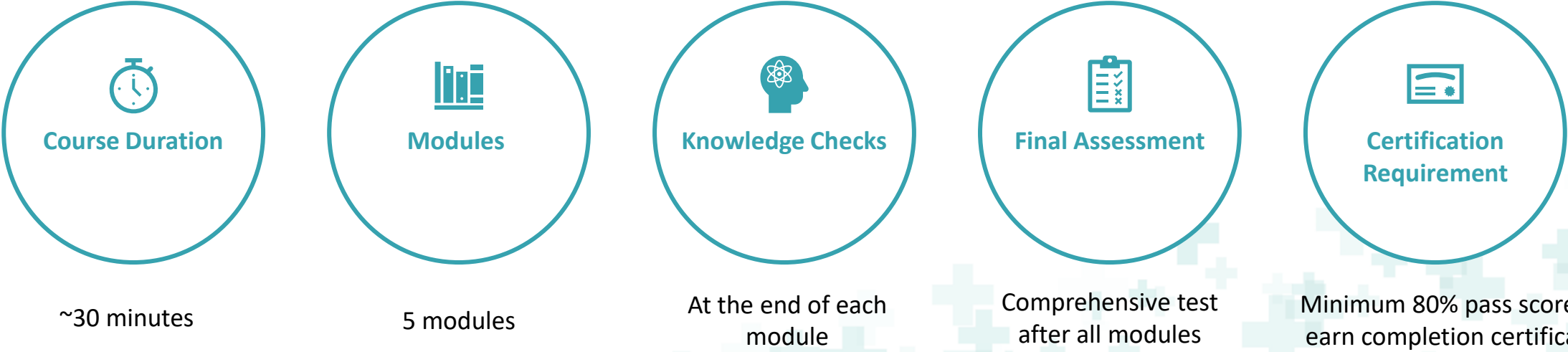
4 Scrollbar

Use to scrub through the media timeline.

5 Playback Controls

Use Play, Pause, Previous, and Next to control module flow.





This course includes five modules:

➤ *Click each module to learn more.*



By the end of this course, you will be able to:



Identify phishing and scam indicators in healthcare communication

Apply secure communication protocols to protect patient data

Report cybersecurity threats using hospital procedures

Demonstrate accountability and vigilance in daily digital practices

This course includes five modules:

➤ *Click each module to learn more.*



Define key healthcare cybersecurity terms using a glossary.

Recognize suspicious sender addresses, URLs, and message elements.

Detect urgency, threats, and emotional manipulation in digital communication.

Differentiate between legitimate and fraudulent formats (e.g., email, text, notifications).



Phishing is a deceptive attempt to trick users into revealing sensitive information or clicking harmful links.

➤ *Click each phishing type to learn how it works and how it appears in healthcare settings.*

Email Phishing

Spear Phishing

Smishing

Vishing



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Vishing

Healthcare Example: A nurse receives an email claim to be from the hospital's IT team, asking her to "verify her login credentials" via a link. The sender address looks slightly off.
E.g., it-support@hosptial.com.



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Email Phishing ✓

Spear Phishing

Smishing

Vishing

Definition: A targeted phishing attack that uses personal or organizational details to appear more convincing.

Healthcare Example: A clinical manager receives an email referencing a recent staff meeting and requesting access to patient records. The message uses her name and department to build trust.



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Email Phishing ✓

Definition: Phishing via SMS or text message, often containing malicious links or urgent requests.

Spear Phishing ✓

Healthcare Example: A support staff member receives a text saying, 'Your hospital account will be suspended. Click here to verify.' The link leads to a fake login page.

Smishing

Vishing



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Email Phishing ✓

Definition: Phishing via voice calls, where attackers impersonate authority figures or technical support.

Spear Phishing ✓

Healthcare Example: A nurse gets a call from someone claiming to be from IT, saying there's a system breach and asking for her login credentials to 'secure the account.'

Smishing ✓

Vishing



Phishing emails often contain subtle clues that reveal they are unsafe.

➤ Click the  button to watch this short video to learn the most common red flags.



Stay Safe from Phishing and Scams

Which of the following email elements indicate a phishing attempt?

➤ Drag each email element into the correct box: Safe or Suspicious.

hr@hospital-careers.com
hr@hospital.com
Immediate Action Required – Payroll Error Detected
Quarterly HR Update
Dear Employee
Dear Nurse Johnson
Link: http://hospital-payroll.verify-now.com
https://hospital.com/hrportal

 Safe

 Suspicious

Which of the following email elements indicate a phishing attempt?

➤ Drag each email element into the correct box: Safe or Suspicious.

hr@hospital-careers.com
Immediate Action Required – Payroll Error Detected
Dear Employee
http://hospital-payroll.verify-now.com
hr@hospital.com
Immediate Action Required – Payroll Error Detected
Quarterly HR Update
Dear Employee

Dear Nurse Johnson



Safe

- hr@hospital.com
- Quarterly HR Update
- Dear Nurse Johnson
- <https://hospital.com/hrportal>

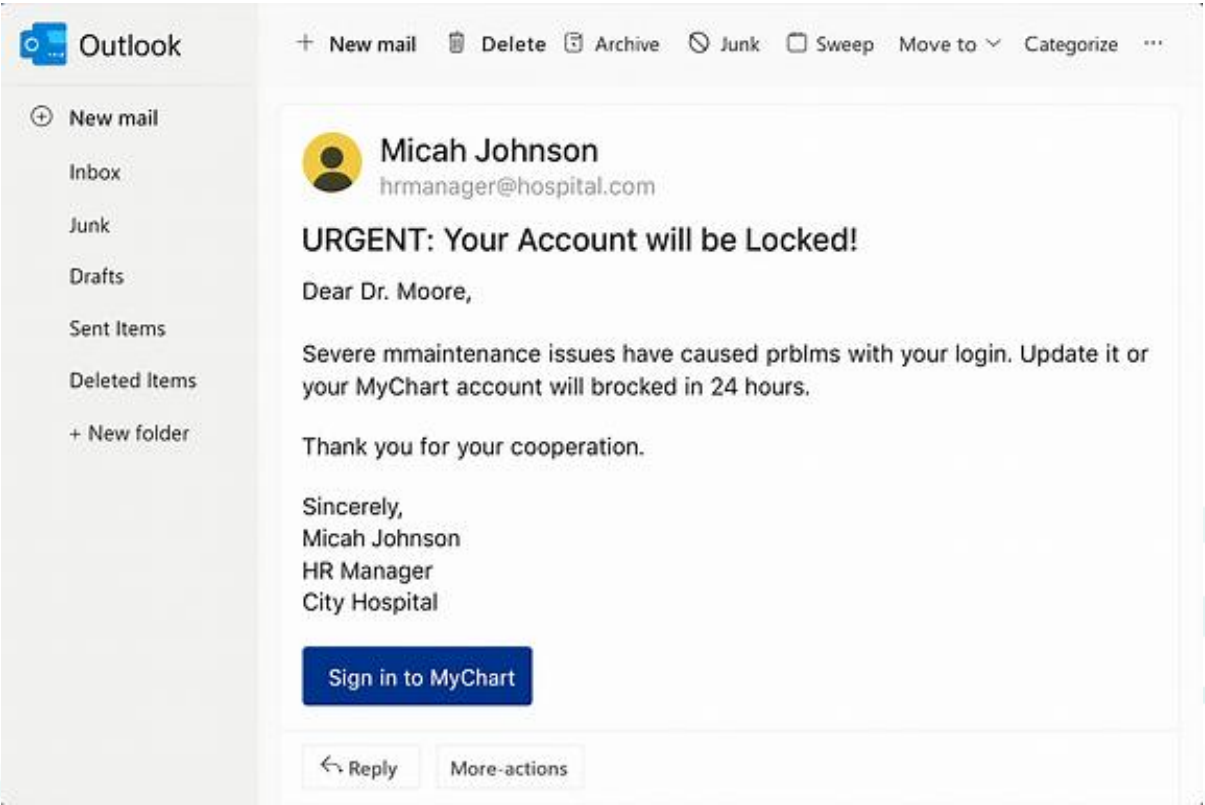


Suspicious

- hr@hospital-careers.com
- Immediate Action Required – Payroll Error Detected
- Dear Employee
- <http://hospital-payroll.verify-now.com>

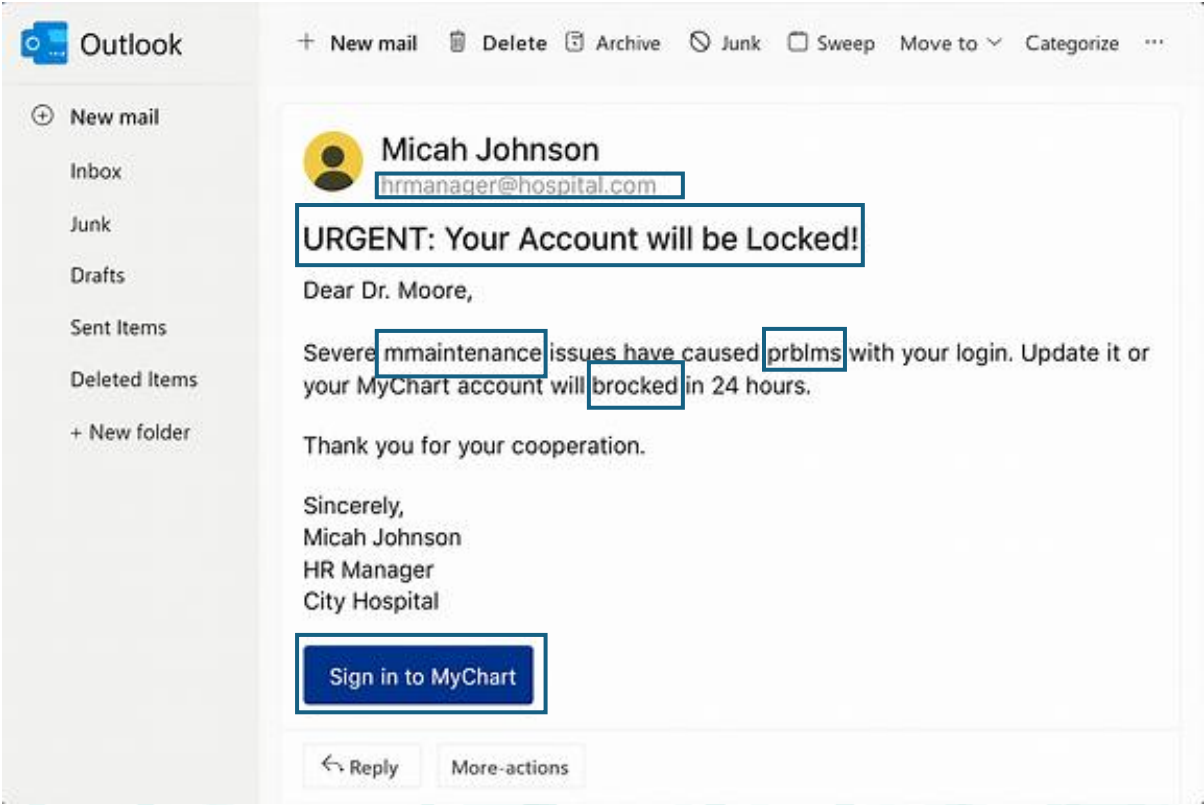
Phishing emails often mimic legitimate hospital communications. Attackers design fraudulent messages to look convincing, but small details reveal the truth.

➤ Click the red flags in the following fraudulent email.

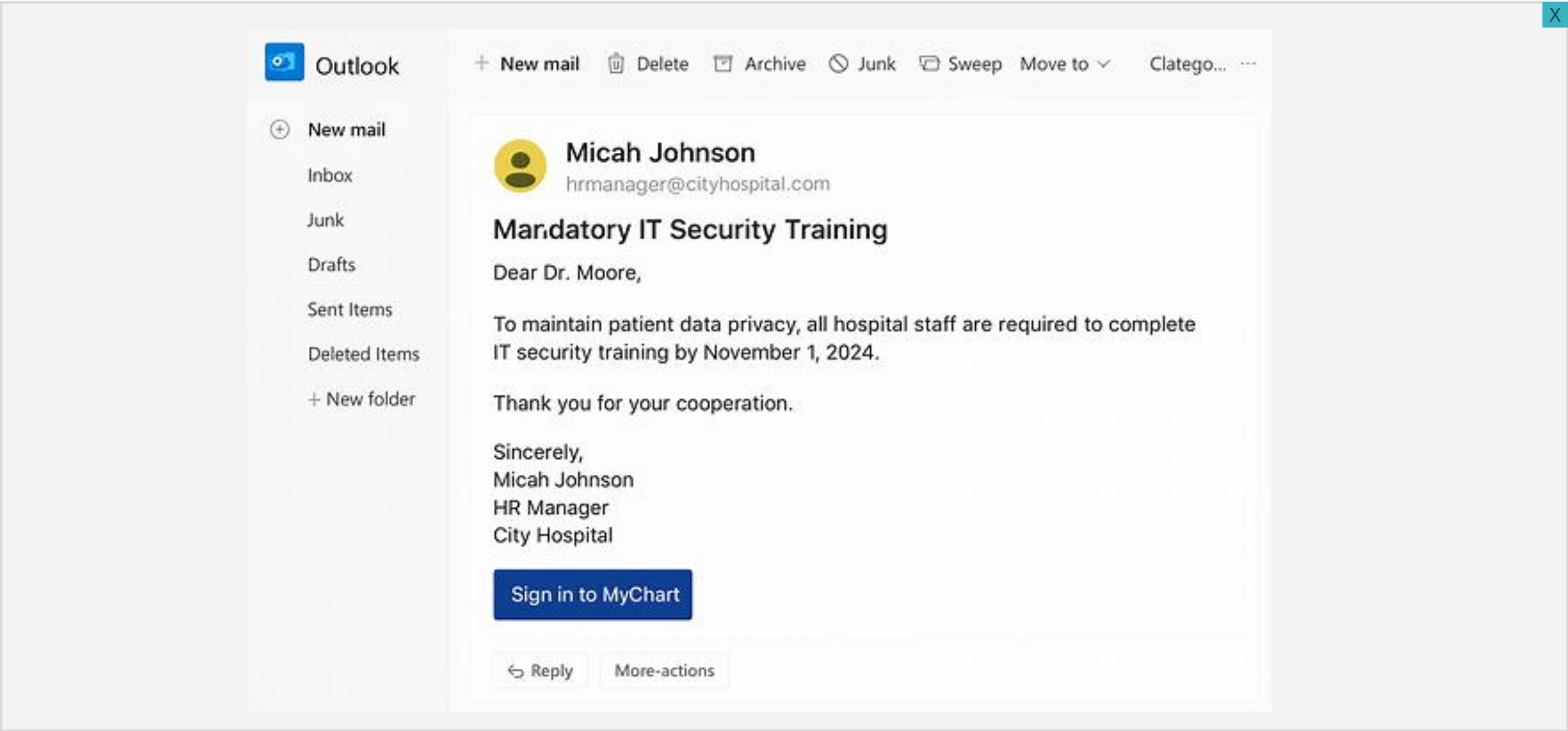


Phishing emails often mimic legitimate hospital communications. Attackers design fraudulent messages to look convincing, but small details reveal the truth.

➤ Click the red flags in the following fraudulent email.



➤ Click here look at a legitimate hospital email to see what safe communication looks like.



Phishing emails often use emotional triggers to bypass your judgment. Attackers rely on fear, urgency, and empathy to pressure healthcare staff into clicking harmful links.

Common Emotional Manipulation Tactics in Phishing Emails

Empathy Trap

Ex: We apologize for the inconvenience

Threat of Consequences

Ex: Failure to act may result in suspension.

Fear and Urgency:

Ex: "Your account will be locked in 24 hours."

Anxiety and Confusion

Ex: "Unusual activity detected on your account."

Relief Bait

Ex: "Click here to restore access."



Which of the following is a clear red flag in a phishing email?

➤ Select the correct answer, then click Submit.

- ☐ Personalized greeting
- ☐ Secure hospital domain
- ☐ Misspelled sender address
- ☐ Routine subject line



SUBMIT

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SUBMIT

What are emotional manipulation tactics commonly used in phishing emails?

➤ Select ALL correct answers apply, then click Submit.

- ☐ Humor and sarcasm
- ☐ Empathy trap
- ☐ Threat of consequences
- ☐ Technical jargon
- ☐ Gratitude overload



SUBMIT

Phishing emails often use urgency to pressure recipients into clicking harmful links.

➤ *Select True or False, then click Submit.*

- ☐ True
- ☐ False



SUBMIT

A phishing email that uses personal details to appear trustworthy is called ____.

➤ *Select the correct answer, then click Submit.*

- ☐ Smishing
- ☐ Vishing
- ☐ Spear Phishing
- ☐ Email Spoofing



SUBMIT

What should you do first after spotting a suspicious email?

➤ Select the correct answer, then click Submit.

- ☐ Reply to verify the sender
- ☐ Click the link to test it
- ☐ Report it to IT Security
- ☐ Forward it to a colleague



SUBMIT

Learners are supported through guided practice activities that simulate real hospital scenarios.

- Click-and-reveal exercises introduce phishing types with healthcare-specific examples.
- Drag-and-drop sorting helps classify safe versus suspicious email elements.
- Hotspot activities allow learners to dissect fraudulent emails by identifying red flags.
- Branching inbox simulations mimic real decision-making under pressure.
- Immediate corrective feedback is provided, incorrect responses prompt retries, while correct answers are reinforced with audio narration and visual cues.

Assessment is embedded throughout the course to ensure both ongoing reinforcement and validated competency.

- Formative assessments appear at the end of each module through periodic knowledge checks.
- Immediate feedback is given for both correct and incorrect answers to strengthen understanding.
- Summative assessment at the end of the course requires a minimum score of 80% to earn certification.
- This dual strategy ensures learners not only complete the course but also demonstrate mastery of cyber hygiene practices.

A blended media strategy is used to enhance engagement, retention, and accessibility.

- AI-generated graphics, stock illustrations, and infographics visualize phishing tactics and emotional manipulation.
- Embedded video demonstrates authentic phishing red flags, bridging theory with practice.
- Audio narration is synchronized with on-screen text (OST) to support dual coding.
- Accessibility features include closed captions, alt text for images, and high-contrast visuals.
- Consistent navigation and mobile responsiveness ensure usability across devices and learner needs.